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(12) **United States Plant Patent**  
**Caster et al.**

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(54) **BLUEBERRY PLANT NAMED**  
**‘DRISBLUEFIVE’**

(50) Latin Name: *Vaccinium corymbosum* L.  
Varietal Denomination: **DrisBlueFive**

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(\*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this  
patent is extended or adjusted under 35  
U.S.C. 154(b) by 85 days.

(21) Appl. No.: **13/573,335**

(22) Filed: **Sep. 11, 2012**

(65) **Prior Publication Data**

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(51) **Int. Cl.**  
*A01H 5/00* (2006.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**  
USPC ..... **Plt./157**

(58) **Field of Classification Search**  
USPC ..... Plt./157  
See application file for complete search history.

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct variety of blueberry plant named ‘Dris-  
BlueFive’ particularly distinguished by having a very low  
chilling requirement, early harvest season with medium to  
high productivity, and firm, sweet berries with aromatic fla-  
vor, is disclosed.

**2 Drawing Sheets**

**1**

Genus and species: *Vaccinium corymbosum* L.  
Variety denomination: ‘DrisBlueFive’.

#### BACKGROUND OF THE NEW PLANT

The invention relates to a new and distinct blueberry vari-  
ety designated ‘DrisBlueFive’ and botanically known as *Vac-*  
*cinium corymbosum* L. This new blueberry variety was dis-  
covered in Santa Cruz, Calif. in June 1999 and originated  
from a cross between the proprietary female parent blueberry  
plant ‘FL 97-16’ (unpatented) and the proprietary male parent  
blueberry plant ‘Windsor’ (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 12,783). The  
original seedling of the new variety was first asexually propa-  
gated at a nursery in Monterey, Calif. ‘DrisBlueFive’ was  
subsequently asexually propagated and underwent further  
testing at a nursery in Santa Cruz, Calif. for thirteen years.  
The present invention has been found to be stable and repro-  
duce true to type through successive asexual propagations via  
softwood cuttings.

Plant Breeder’s Rights for this variety have not been  
applied for. ‘DrisBlueFive’ has not been made publicly avail-  
able or sold more than one year prior to the filing date of this  
application.

#### SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The following are the most outstanding and distinguishing  
characteristics of this new cultivar when grown under normal  
horticultural practices in Santa Cruz, Calif.

1. A very low chilling requirement;
2. Early harvest season with medium to high productivity;  
and
3. Firm, sweet berries with aromatic flavor.

#### DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

This new blueberry plant is illustrated by the accompany-  
ing photographs which show fruit of the plant as well as the

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flowers and leaves. The colors shown are as true as can be  
reasonably obtained by conventional photographic proce-  
dures. The photographs are of plants that are 13 years old.

FIG. 1 shows a close-up of the mature flowers.

FIG. 2 shows a close-up of the leaves.

FIG. 3 shows a close-up of the whole fruit and a cross-  
section of the fruit.

#### DESCRIPTION OF THE NEW CULTIVAR

The following detailed description sets forth the distinctive  
characteristics of ‘DrisBlueFive.’ The data which define these  
characteristics is based on observations taken in Santa Cruz,  
Calif. from 1999 to 2012. This description is in accordance  
with UPOV terminology. Color designations, color descrip-  
tions, and other phenotypical descriptions may deviate from  
the stated values and descriptions depending upon variation  
in environmental, seasonal, climatic and cultural conditions.  
‘DrisBlueFive’ has not been observed under all possible envi-  
ronmental conditions. The botanical description of ‘Dris-  
BlueFive’ was taken from 13 year-old plants. Color refer-  
ences are primarily to The R.H.S. Colour Chart of The Royal  
Horticultural Society of London (R.H.S.) (2007 edition).  
Descriptive terminology follows the *Plant Identification Ter-*  
*minology, An Illustrated Glossary*, 2<sup>nd</sup> edition by James G.  
Harris and Melinda Woolf Harris, unless where otherwise  
defined.

#### DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

Classification:

*Family*.—Ericaceae.

*Botanical*.—*Vaccinium corymbosum* L.

*Common name*.—Blueberry.

*Variety name*.—‘DrisBlueFive’.



## Parentage:

*Female parent.*—The proprietary blueberry plant ‘FL 97-16’ (unpatented).

*Male parent.*—The proprietary blueberry plant ‘Wind-  
sor’ (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 12,783).

## Plant:

*Size.*—Medium.

*Height.*—126.2 cm.

*Width.*—157.2 cm.

*Length/width ratio.*—0.8.

*Plant vigor.*—Strong.

*Growth habit.*—Semi-erect.

*Productivity.*—Medium to high.

*Cold hardiness.*—Medium.

*Chilling requirement.*—Very low; 150-250 chilling  
hours.

*Propagation.*—Soft wood cuttings.

*Time of vegetative bud burst.*—Early to medium.

*Fruiting type.*—Only on one-year-old shoots.

*Cane renewal.*—Strong.

*Internode length (upper half on one-year old shoot).*—  
33.8 mm.

*One-year old canes (young canes).*—Length: 107.0 cm.  
Diameter at the base: 9.0 mm. Diameter at the tip: 5.0  
mm. Texture: Smooth. Color (One-year old shoot,  
branch and canes): RHS 144C (Medium yellow-  
green).

*Five-year old canes (mature canes).*—Length: 132.0  
cm. Diameter at the base: 17.0 mm. Diameter at the  
tip: 3.8 mm. Texture: Rough. Color: RHS N200B  
(Medium brown).

## Leaves:

*Length.*—Medium; 4.84 cm.

*Width.*—Medium; 2.97 cm.

*Length/width ratio.*—1.6; longer than broad.

*Shape.*—Elliptic.

*Apex.*—Acute.

*Base.*—Cuneate.

*Margin.*—Entire.

*Glossiness.*—Medium.

*Pubescence.*—Glabrous (Absent).

*Sheath.*—Absent.

*Arrangement.*—Alternate.

*Venation.*—Reticulate.

*Color.*—Upper surface: Dark; RHS 189A (Dark greyed-  
green). Lower surface: Medium; RHS 191A (Medium  
greyed-green).

*Appearance of leaf bud.*—Early.

*Internode length (one-year old shoot, upper half).*—  
Medium; 17.58 mm.

## Petiole:

*Length.*—2.5 mm.

*Diameter.*—1.71 mm.

*Color.*—RHS N145B (Light yellow-green).

## Flowers:

*Length (excluding peduncle).*—Long; 9.88 mm.

*Diameter.*—8.08 mm.

*Length/width ratio.*—1.2.

*Color.*—RHS 155C (White).

*Flower bud.*—Length: 8.7 mm. Width: 3.3 mm. Number  
of flowers per bud: 7. Color on mature buds: RHS 65C  
(Light red-purple) and RHS 155B (White).

*Petal width.*—4.74 mm.

*Fragrance.*—Very faint or absent.

*Time of beginning flowering on one-year shoot.*—Early.

*Time of flowering (50% full bloom).*—Early; March 6.

*Pedicel.*—Length: 8.51 mm. Diameter: 1.09 mm. Color:  
RHS 145B (Medium yellow-green).

*Corolla.*—Aperture diameter: 2.62 mm. Shape:  
Urceolate. Size of corolla tube: Medium. Corolla tube  
color: Very weak or absent; RHS N155C (White).  
Ridges on tube: Absent.

*Peduncle length.*—3.49 cm.

## Reproductive organs:

*Style length (including stigma).*—Medium; 6.51 mm.

*Style color.*—RHS 144B (Medium yellow-green).

*Ovary color.*—RHS 189B (Medium greyed-green).

*Pollen amount.*—Medium to high.

*Pollen color.*—RHS 9D (Light yellow).

*Anther color.*—RHS 164A (Medium greyed-orange).

## Fruit:

*Size.*—Medium to large.

*Length.*—12.46 mm.

*Width.*—17.09 mm.

*Length/width ratio.*—0.7.

*Fruit pedicel diameter.*—1.23 mm.

*Weight.*—1.8 g.

*Number of berries per cluster.*—9.

*Cluster density.*—Medium.

*Shape in longitudinal sections.*—Oblate.

*Intensity of green color (immature fruit with bloom).*—  
Medium; RHS 139C (Medium green).

*Color of skin (immature fruit without bloom).*—RHS  
N77A (Dark purple).

*Color of skin (mature fruit without bloom).*—RHS  
N186A (Greyed-purple).

*Color of skin (mature fruit with bloom).*—RHS 107D  
(Light blue).

*Intensity of bloom (mature fruit).*—Strong to very  
strong.

*Attitude of sepals.*—Incurving and erect.

*Calyx.*—Diameter of basin: Large; 7.09 mm. Depth of  
basin: Deep; 4.44 mm. Diameter/depth ratio: 1.6.

*Flesh color.*—RHS 149C (Light yellow-green).

*Firmness.*—Firm.

*Sweetness.*—Medium.

*Acidity.*—Low.

*Time of beginning of fruit ripening (one-year old shoots)*  
.—Medium.

*Harvest season.*—Early.

*Harvest interval.*—May 4 to July 5.

## Seeds:

*Length.*—1.62 mm.

*Width.*—1.18 mm.

*Length/width ratio.*—1.4.

*Abundance.*—Medium to high.

*Color.*—RHS 164A (Medium greyed-orange).

Resistance to pests and diseases: Data not available.

COMPARISON WITH PARENTAL AND  
COMMERCIAL VARIETIES

‘DrisBlueFive’ differs from the male parent blueberry vari-  
ety ‘Windsor’ (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 12,783) in that ‘DrisBlue-  
Five’ has elliptic shaped leaves with an acute apex and a berry  
weight of 1.8 grams, whereas ‘Windsor’ has oval to lanceolate  
shaped leaves with an acuminate apex and a berry weight of  
2.48 grams. Additionally, ‘DrisBlueFive’ has a low chilling  
requirement of 150 to 250 hours, whereas ‘Windsor’ has a  
higher chilling requirement of about 300 hours.



‘DrisBlueFive’ differs from the commercial variety ‘Dris-BlueOne’ (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 20,449) in that ‘DrisBlueFive’ has leaves with an acute apex and firm berries with low acidity, whereas ‘DrisBlueOne’ has leaves with a broadly acute apex and very firm berries with medium acidity. Additionally, ‘DrisBlueFive’ has a very low chilling requirement, whereas ‘DrisBlueOne’ has a medium chilling requirement.

‘DrisBlueFive’ differs from the commercial variety ‘Dris-BlueTwo’ (U.S. Plant Pat. No. 20,488), in that ‘DrisBlueFive’

has leaves with an cuneate base and an entire margin, whereas ‘DrisBlueTwo’ has leaves with a broadly acute base and a serrulate margin. Additionally, ‘DrisBlueFive’ has oblate shaped berries with low acidity, whereas ‘DrisBlueTwo’ has nearly spherical shaped berries with medium acidity.

We claim:

1. A new and distinct variety of blueberry plant named ‘DrisBlueFive’ as shown and described herein.

\* \* \* \* \*



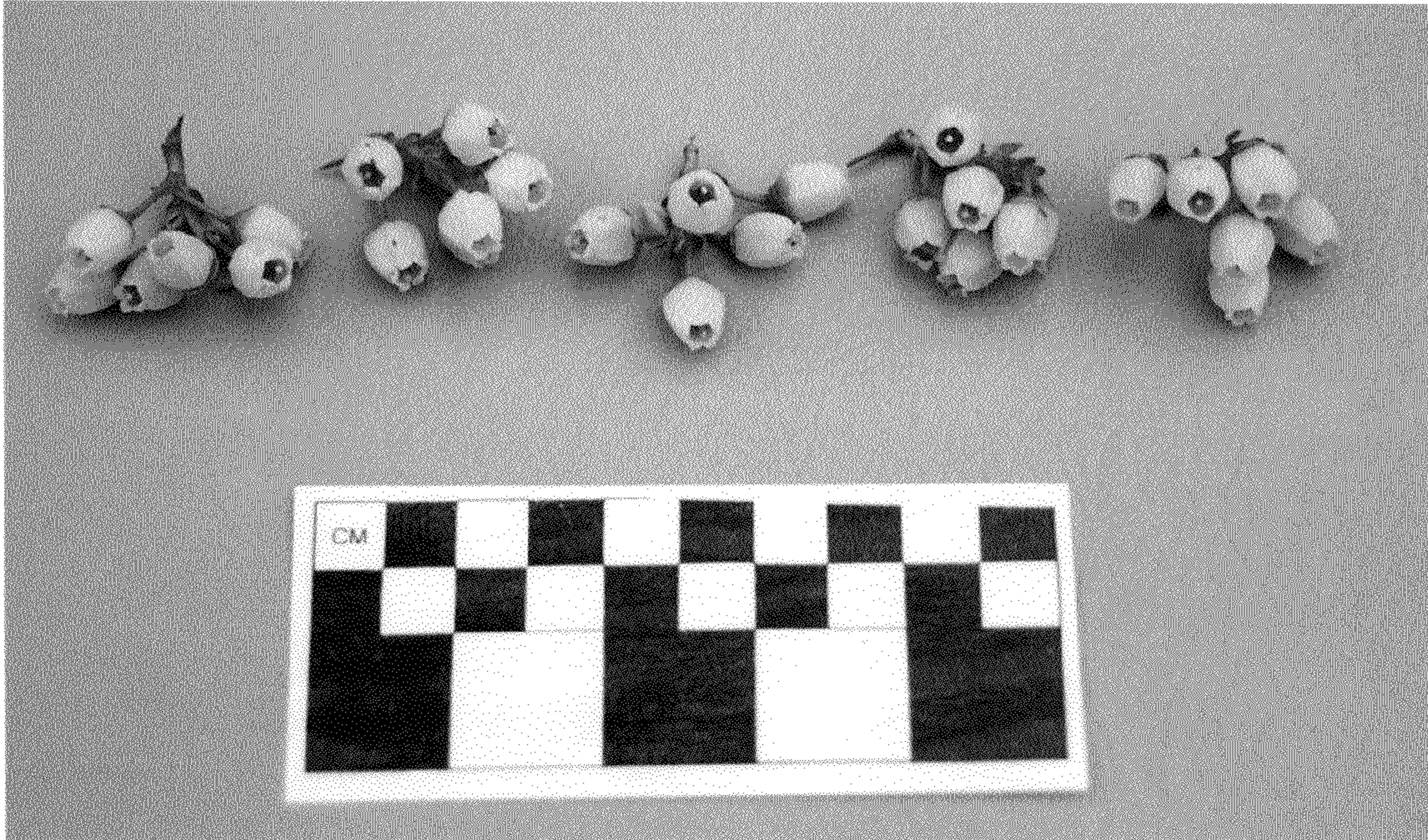


FIG. 1

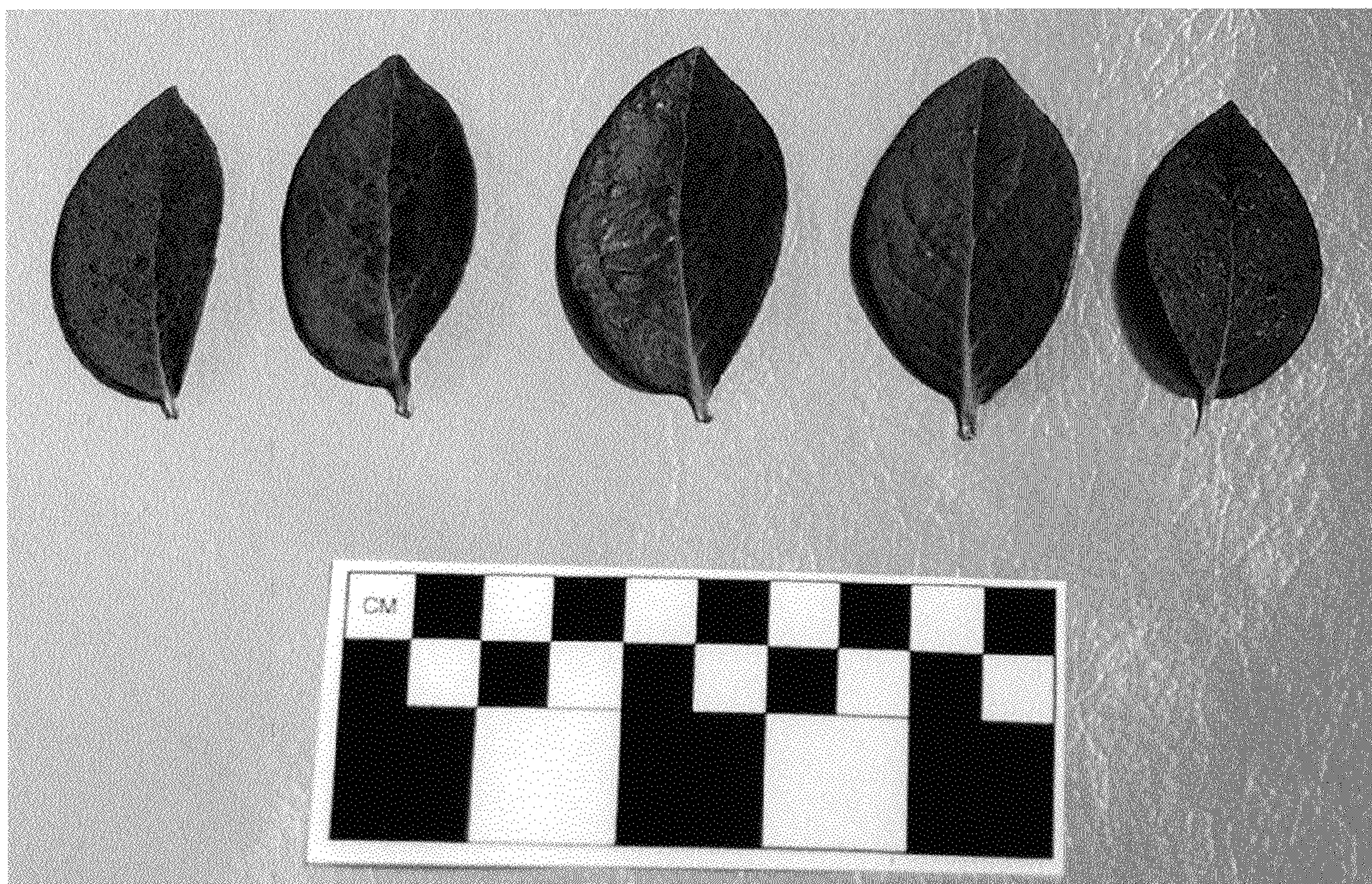


FIG. 2



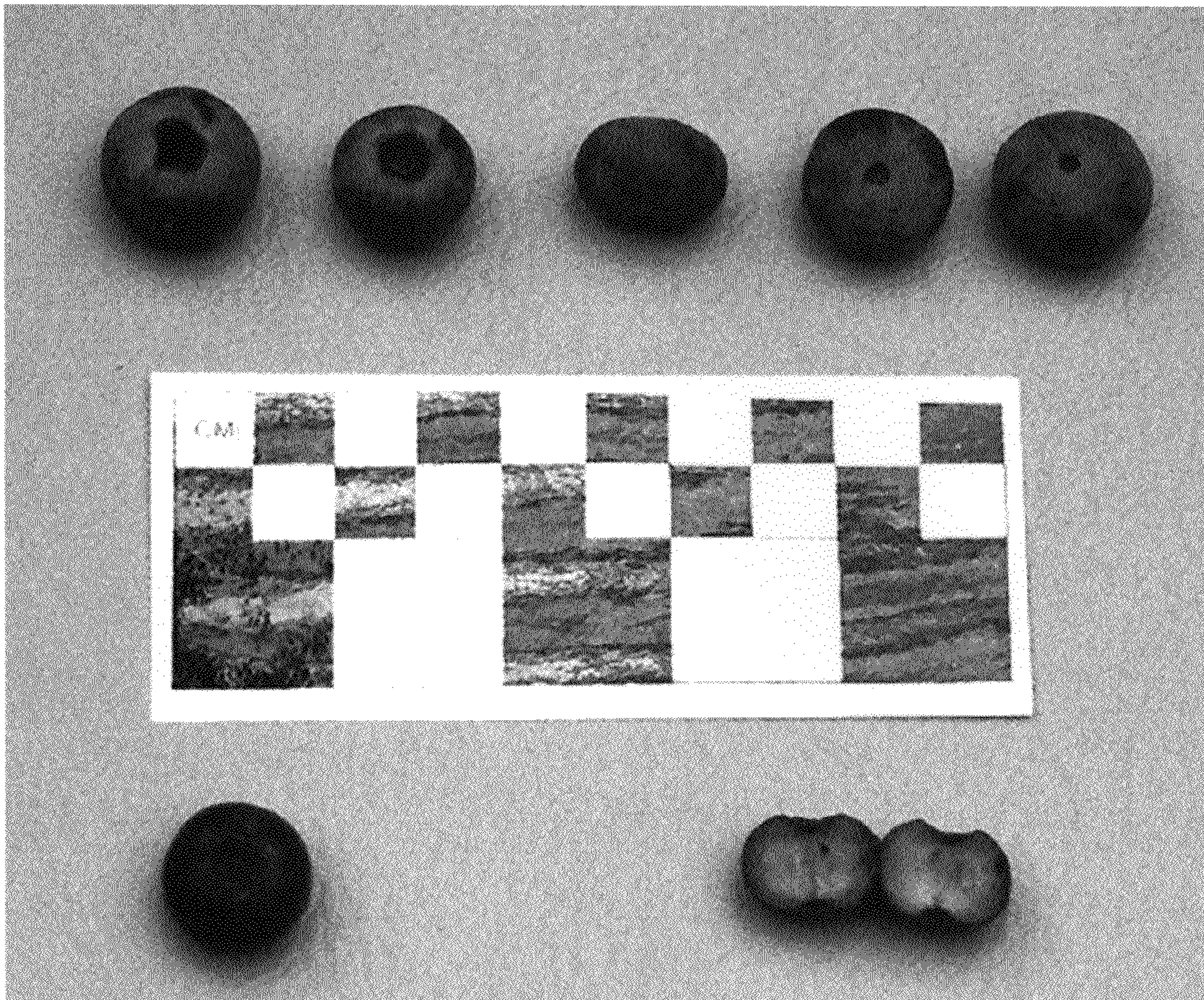


FIG. 3



UNITED STATES PATENT AND TRADEMARK OFFICE  
**CERTIFICATE OF CORRECTION**

PATENT NO. : PP24,489 P3  
APPLICATION NO. : 13/573335  
DATED : May 27, 2014  
INVENTOR(S) : Brian K. Caster et al.

Page 1 of 1

It is certified that error appears in the above-identified patent and that said Letters Patent is hereby corrected as shown below:

In the Specification

In Column 1, Line 9, delete “female” and insert -- male --, therefor.

In Column 1, Line 10, delete “male” and insert -- female --, therefor.

In Column 3, Line 2, delete “Female” and insert -- Male --, therefor.

In Column 3, Line 4, delete “Male” and insert -- Female --, therefor.

In Column 4, Line 59, delete “male” and insert -- female --, therefor.

Signed and Sealed this  
Third Day of January, 2017



Michelle K. Lee  
*Director of the United States Patent and Trademark Office*